



MENTAL STRENGTH

Self-efficacy

Self-efficacy

24%

of participants experience
challenges with self-efficacy

95%

Self-efficacy is a strength for 95%
of people with **high levels** of
resilience

69%

Self-efficacy is a strength for 69%
of people with **average levels** of
resilience

9%

Self-efficacy is a strength for 9%
of people with **low levels** of
resilience



Self-efficacy



What is self-efficacy?

Self-efficacy is a person's belief in their ability to succeed in a particular situation.

Performing a task successfully strengthens our sense of self-efficacy.



Self-efficacy influences the goals we set for ourselves, how we approach a task, our motivation to engage in a task, the level of effort, degree of persistence and our performance on that task.



PEOPLE WITH A STRONG SENSE OF SELF-EFFICACY

- Are excited by challenges and difficult tasks or situations
- Work better with ambiguity and uncertainty
- Recover quickly from setbacks and disappointments
- View challenging problems as tasks to be mastered
- Set more challenging goals
- Attribute setbacks to insufficient effort or knowledge (both of which can be acquired)



PEOPLE WITH A WEAK SENSE OF SELF-EFFICACY

- Avoid challenging tasks
- Believe that difficult tasks and situations are beyond their capabilities
- Are concerned about potential failure rather than success
- Focus on personal failings and negative outcomes
- Quickly lose confidence in their abilities

The impact of High Self-efficacy v Low Self-efficacy in The Workplace

Self-efficacy has been correlated positively with workplace performance, burnout, the experience of stress, and career development. Studies have found interventions to boost self-efficacy increased performance by 28% (Stajkovic & Luthans 1998).

Factors that may mediate this include motivation, training, leadership input/supervision, education, and skill level supporting the case for targeted interventions.

Self-efficacy affects learning and performance in 5 ways:



Goals - High self-efficacy encourages individuals to increase the difficulty of self-set goals which requires greater effort and competence to attain the desired goal.



Performance - Employees with high self-efficacy are confident of success so work hard at new tasks which enhances performance.



Persistence - employees with high self-efficacy persist at tasks confident of their abilities to learn and execute it successfully.



Resilience to setbacks - Employees with high self-efficacy will recover faster from setbacks.



Stress - High self-efficacy increases an individual's sense of control over challenges which buffers the stress response.

How Self-efficacy Develops



PERSONAL/MASTERY EXPERIENCES

Looking back at previous successes and understanding how you achieved them, helping you build confidence in your ability to create future success.

'I've done this before, I can do it again'



VICARIOUS EXPERIENCE

Looking at what role models have achieved and feeling that you can achieve the same.

'If they can do it, then so can I'



SOCIAL PERSUASION

Being encouraged and convinced by others that you can achieve your objectives.

'You've got this'



PHYSIOLOGICAL MAKE-UP

Having the ability to overcome moods, stress or other physical limitations in any given situation e.g. public speaking.

'I can do this'

Improving Self-efficacy Best Practice

 Self-efficacy, the belief in our ability to succeed, is vital for growth, goal achievement and resilience



Set Clear & Achievable Daily Goals

This builds confidence and a sense of accomplishment. Celebrate small wins.



Visualise Success

Picture yourself successfully completing a task or overcoming a challenge, this will reinforce your belief in your abilities.



Positive Self-Talk

Focus on the positive: 'It may not work as planned' becomes 'I learn and grow from every experience.' Repeating thoughts strengthens the neural pathways linked to them.



Reflect on Past Successes

Write them in a 'Success Journal'. When you reflect on the skills and efforts that led to those successes it reinforces your belief in your capabilities.



Learn from Role Models

Identify role models and study their path to success. Collaborate with peers or mentors with high self-efficacy, or join a goal-oriented, supportive group.



Master New Skills

Engage in activities that challenge you and require new skills outside your comfort zone. This will demonstrate your ability to learn and adapt.



Cultivate a Growth Mindset

Embrace challenges as opportunities to learn and develop. Regularly reflect on how you handle challenges and what you learnt.



Seek Constructive Feedback

Regularly seek feedback from peers and mentors to identify your strengths and areas for development.

Self-efficacy

Exercises



EXERCISE 1

Analyse a Success

Think of a situation where you were successful in a task, project or challenge.

Describe the situation. How did it make you feel? What learnings did you take? How did it impact your ability to take on the next challenge?



EXERCISE 2

Analyse Declining a Task

Think of a situation where you declined to take on a project or a task or a presentation.

Describe the situation. What were you feeling?

Self-efficacy



EXERCISE 3

The Success Bank

This is an exercise to reflect on and document your past successes and to think about what made you successful.

You can refer to them in the future when you are asked to take on a task or role where you may be having doubts about your ability to succeed.

1



Describe the situation



Which capabilities helped you to be successful and what did you learn?



How did your success make you feel?

2

Once you have written it down, put it in the 'Success Bank'. This could be a desk drawer, a filing cabinet, pinned to the wall or stored electronically.

3

Every time you have a new success, document it and add it to the Success Bank. You can also add recognitions from managers, peers or customers.

4

When you are faced with a situation where you have been asked to take on a new role or task and you are doubting your ability to succeed, go to the Success Bank and read out loud the different examples of your past achievements and recognitions.